FDE INTERVIEW PREP #02

FDE INTERVIEW PREP · ISSUE 02 OF 08

Agentic AI interview questions.

LangGraph, MCP, tool calling and human approval.

02

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Questions and short answers

01 **Workflow or agent?**

Fixed steps: workflow. Open-ended steps: agent, with limits.

02 **Why LangGraph?**

Explicit state, branches, retries and human interrupts.

03 **What is MCP?**

A standard way to expose tools and data to models.

04 **How do you stop loops?**

Step and cost budgets, and a clear stop condition.

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A safe tool call

1. Model proposes a call
2. Validate arguments in code
3. Check user permission
4. Approval if it writes
5. Execute + audit log

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The follow-ups

01 **How do you evaluate an agent?**

Task success, tool-call correctness and cost per task.

02 **Agent memory?**

Short-term state in the graph, long-term in a store with rules.

03 **MCP security?**

Trusted servers only, scoped auth, every tool reviewed.

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How to answer

DO

- ✓ Start with the smallest autonomy
- ✓ Name the approval points
- ✓ Show the audit trail
- ✓ Measure cost per task

AVOID

- ✗ Multi-agent by default
- ✗ Unlimited tool access
- ✗ Skip failure handling
- ✗ Treat MCP as a security boundary

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Practise these

- [x] Draw a LangGraph state machine
- [x] Design an approval step
- [x] Explain MCP in two sentences
- [x] Evaluate a tool-using agent
- [x] Handle a tool timeout

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KEY TAKEAWAY

The best agent answer starts with the least autonomy that works.

→ Workflow first, agent when needed

→ Validate and authorise every tool call

→ Approval for anything that writes

YOUR TURN

Where do you put the human approval step in your agents?

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